sions—health, education, and standard of living. While the NITI Aayog counts families with an annual income of less than Rs 1.2 lakh as poor, in Haryana, it's Rs 1.8 lakh. The national think-tank, studying the data collated in 2011-12, has listed Haryana's poverty at 29.3 per cent. However, the CM says they have dealt with the situation scientifically in the past decade. "In the next two years, there will be no family in Haryana with less than this income." Haryana, which houses the headquarters and offices of almost 300 MNCs, is expecting revenue receipts of Rs 1.1 lakh crore, an increase of 15 per cent from the revised estimates of 2021-22—Rs 93,488 crore. During the same time, the state is expecting to spend Rs 1.4 lakh crore.

Most Improved Small State: Manipur

In the past five years, Manipur has seen a healthy spike in economic activities. The state's GSDP expanded at a CAGR of 11.67 per cent between 2015-16 and 2022-23. The relative peace in the past five years has resulted in massive gains—the inflow of international tourists went up by more than 200 per cent since 2016, adding to local revenue and employment opportunities with top brands. Because Manipur is primarily a consuming state, it's earning better tax revenue through GST, accounting for around 70 per cent of the tax collected. This has motivated the state government to increase capital expenditure by 35 per cent in the previous fiscal. But, with almost no source of the state's own non-tax revenue, fiscal deficit remains a big worry, estimated at 6.5 per cent of the GSDP. While always welcoming external investments and industries, Chief Minister N. Biren Singh's government has sought to find the road to economic resurgence within the state. "Every household has a kitchen garden, a pond and a small poultry or piggery farm. People were self-reliant on these sources earlier. Our objective is to not only make them self-reliant again but also make them produce for other states," says Singh. Only will their effort bear fruit. ■

–Jumana Shah, Anilesh S. Mahajan and Kaushik Deka



HEAR, HEAR
Jharkhand CM Hemant Soren

ANI

CATEGORY WINNERS **INFRASTRUCTURE**

THE STEADY BUILD-UP

New roads and airports mark progress in Jharkhand, Goa and Punjab. With its new railways, Manipur breaks fresh ground



Quality of life anywhere in the modern world is directly proportional to the quality of infrastructure—roads, supply of power and piped water, rail and air connectivity. Mobile/ internet connectivity is important too. Another factor is the number of projects completed, in relation to those sanctioned. These and other elements were taken into account to arrive at the Best Performing/ Most Improved states in this category.

Best Performing Big State: Punjab

Punjab is justifiably proud of its web of quality roads, both national and state highways, that connect every town with Chandigarh. The 2018-19 data of MORTH ratio of road length to the total area is 2.94, and the ratio of road length (every square km) to 1,000 vehicles is 0.10 in Punjab—among India's best. It is among the first states to provide electricity to all households, and the National Family Health Survey (NFHS) data shows that it has 98.8 per cent coverage of improved drinking water. The state has two international airports at Chandigarh and Amritsar. Two major projects are expected to be completed by 2022—an expressway